

RICHARD BAGSHAW

SENIOR LARAVEL DEVELOPER

DETAILS

LOCATION

Nottingham, UK

EMAIL

richard@bagshaw.co.uk

NATIONALITY

British

SKILLS

BACKEND

- Laravel
- Eloquent
- PHP 8
- MySQL
- SQLite
- Redis
- S3
- Livewire
- Sanctum
- Passport
- Horizon
- Reverb
- Nova
- Filament
- Laravel Forge
- Laravel Envoyer
- Laravel Cloud
- REST APIs

AI & TOOLING

- Claude
- Codex
- Gemini
- Claude Code
- Subagents
- Hooks
- Slash commands
- Claude Skills
- MCPs
- Plan Mode
- Git
- Docker
- CI/CD
- Tinkerwell
- Bugsnag

PROFILE

I'm a Senior Laravel Developer based in Nottingham who has been building for the web since 1996. I'm a programmer at heart and spend a lot of my own time staying current with the rapidly evolving landscape of web development.

My core expertise lies in PHP, Laravel, and JavaScript. I've been working with Laravel since version 3 and have grown with the framework through every major release. Alongside this, I have extensive experience with a range of JavaScript libraries and frameworks, including Vue, React, and earlier in my career, jQuery. I also enjoy exploring other programming languages outside of my day job, such as Rust and Go.

Writing clean, understandable, and maintainable code is central to how I work. I lean heavily on automated testing, code reviews, and feedback loops, while balancing technical excellence with the business reality that the pursuit of perfection shouldn't come at an unsustainable cost.

More recently, AI-assisted development has become a core part of how I work. I use LLMs like Claude, Codex, and Gemini in my day-to-day coding, but always in a responsible and professional way. Strong automated test coverage, careful prompting, and thorough human review are the guardrails that keep the output trustworthy and let me move quickly without ever trading away the quality of the work.

FRONTEND

HTML

CSS

Tailwind

JavaScript

Vue (Composition API)

React

Alpine

Tailwind UI

Inertia.js

Vite

TESTING & CODE QUALITY

PHPUnit

PEST

Behat

PHPStan

Larastan

PHPCS

Laravel Pint

Mockery

Faker

Code Reviews

HOBBIES

Outside of work I like to balance time on and off the screen. Running and gravel riding take me out into the countryside on my bike, which is a great way to switch off and clear my head.

Being a programmer at heart, I also spend a lot of my downtime learning other programming languages and experimenting with new technologies. At the moment I'm dipping into Rust and Go alongside my day-to-day stack.

When I do settle in front of a screen for leisure, I enjoy gaming, from immersive story-driven experiences through to competitive multiplayer.

LINKS

- LinkedIn
- GitHub

EMPLOYMENT HISTORY

Senior Laravel Developer, [Plannr Technologies](#)

Full-time

Jul 2025 - Present

At Plannr I work on a CRM platform built for the UK financial advice industry. My day-to-day focus is on Laravel API backends, with regular contributions to the Vue.js front end as features demand.

A significant part of my role involves integrating modern LLMs such as Claude, Codex, and Gemini into the development workflow. I've built up a set of repeatable, Claude-Code-driven workflows that assist with everything from boilerplate scaffolding through to code review and refactoring, accelerating delivery without giving up code quality.

I'm very conscious that AI-assisted development is a delicate balance. Strong testing, deliberate prompting, and thorough human review are the guardrails that let me move fast safely, with AI amplifying my output rather than replacing the rigour behind it.

Freelance Laravel Developer, [Develo Design](#)

Contract

Jan 2025 - Jul 2025

A freelance contract building Laravel applications that integrated Magento shop data with AI services, hosted on Laravel Cloud. The work centred on designing pipelines that consumed product and order data from Magento, enriched it through AI tooling, and exposed the results back into the wider Laravel application stack.

Freelance Laravel Developer, [Alt Design](#)

Contract, Derby

Jan 2025 - Jul 2025

A freelance contract with Alt Design, a digital agency based in Derby, working across a varied set of client Laravel projects using Laravel, Livewire, and Vue. The agency setting meant switching between codebases regularly, which reinforced my preference for clean, well-tested, easy-to-pick-up code.

Software Developer, [Mumsnet](#)

Full-time, London

Jul 2023 - Dec 2024

Mumsnet is one of the UK's largest online communities, serving millions of requests a day. I worked across a Laravel and Livewire codebase that was actively migrating to Vue, building features, maintaining core functionality, and continually optimising the platform for performance and scale.

Notable features I built include a custom "gratitude" system (Mumsnet's twist on the classic "like"), an advanced content-matching system that used Google's natural language processing APIs to link user-generated content with relevant on-site content, and a site-wide polling feature that members could create and engage with across different sections of the site.

Alongside the feature work I refactored legacy code, modernised parts of the codebase to take advantage of PHP 8.x (attributes, enums, match expressions, constructor property promotion), and made sure new and changed code was covered by PHPUnit and Laravel's testing tools, with Jest covering the Vue layer.

PHP Developer on [Ranges.io](#), [The Sans Institute](#)

Full-time

Aug 2021 - Jun 2023

Ranges.io is a "capture the flag" platform used in cybersecurity training programmes run by SANS. I worked on the backend, a PHP and MySQL service built on the Slim PHP micro-framework and exposed as an API to a React front end. AWS Lambda handled the more intensive workloads, and development ran locally in Docker.

The team worked in two-week sprints with strong upfront planning and refinement, and I leaned heavily on PHPUnit, Behat, PHPStan, PHPCS, and ESLint to keep the codebase consistent and trustworthy.

Laravel Developer, [Twindig.com](#)

Contract

May 2019 - Aug 2021

At Twindig I was the second developer on a two-person team (alongside the CTO), building an MVP property platform that let homeowners manage all of their property information in one place. The stack was Laravel with Livewire and Alpine, Vue where richer interactivity was needed, and Tailwind CSS for styling, hosted via Laravel Forge on Digital Ocean.

The role was deliberately broad: building user interfaces with Tailwind, writing Livewire components, and wiring up backend systems. Notable pieces include a document library backed by Eloquent and Digital Ocean Spaces for file storage, and a polymorphic tagging system that let tags be attached to any entity across the platform.

Laravel Developer, [Rentora](#)

Contract

May 2019 - Nov 2019

A six-month contract building features for a platform that helped landlords manage tenant relationships through digital and automated systems, including automated rent collection via Stripe. The architecture was a Laravel REST API consumed by a Vue front end (styled with Tailwind), hosted on Laravel Forge.

My main focus was the property listings feature, which I built as a Vue page backed by Laravel API endpoints, with server-side rendering in place so that the heavily JavaScript-driven page retained its SEO.

Backend Developer, [GatherContent.com](https://gathercontent.com)

Full-time

Jan 2016 - May 2019

During three and a half years at GatherContent I worked primarily as a backend developer on the API, handling deployments via Envoy, Forge, and AWS. The role was also where I first picked up React, contributing regularly to front-end features in React, Redux, and ES6.

Key contributions included:

- Developing tools to ensure full GDPR compliance.
- Building hundreds of API endpoints, working with TDD, pair programming, and thorough pull request reviews.
- Migrating development environments from AWS EC2 to local Docker / Homestead setups.
- Building the back end of a live collaboration tool that allowed multiple users to edit a document simultaneously.
- Leading the upgrade of all codebases from Laravel 4.1 through to Laravel 5.8.
- Integrating Algolia for in-app content search, a heavily requested feature.
- Building a commenting system that let users comment on any part of a document.
- Implementing email and in-app notifications via Laravel's notification system.

I also regularly helped customers with technical issues that went beyond the scope of standard support.

Last updated May 2026